



THE HSM METHOD

5 Daily Habits of Students Who Score '**Distinction**'

In Trinity College London Exams — and why the secret has nothing to do with talent, and everything to do with what happens in the **other 167 hours** of the week.

100%

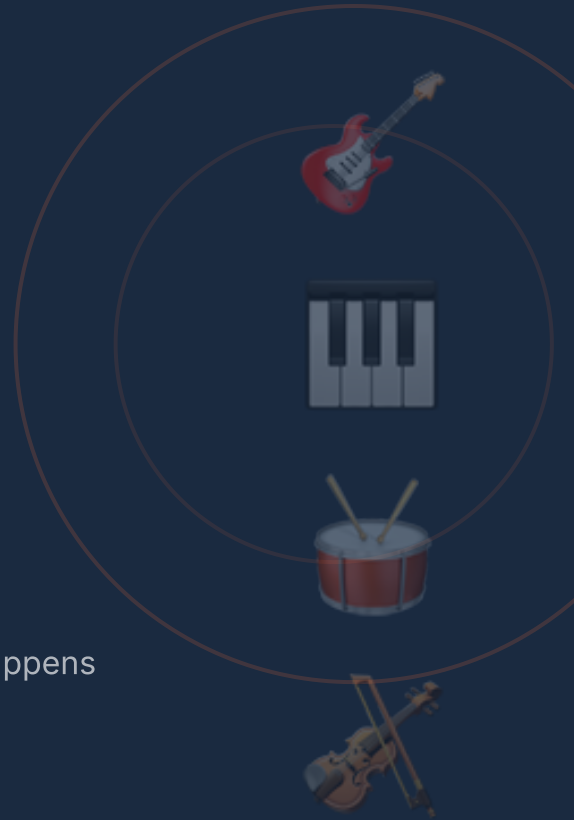
MERIT OR DISTINCTION RATE

167

HOURS TRAINED FOR

100+

ACTIVE STUDENTS



The 167–Hour Reality Check

Every year, thousands of parents enrol their children in music lessons hoping for brilliant results. Yet the vast majority of students stall, get frustrated, and eventually quit. Why? **Standard music schools focus entirely on the 1 hour a week the student spends with an instructor.** That leaves 167 other hours entirely unguided.

At HSM, we flipped the model. Our faculty — **Joshua, Mriganko, Subroto, Isaac Lawrence, and Sangeeta** — have isolated the exact 5 daily micro-habits that separate a struggling student from a Distinction-grade performer. The result? **100% of students who have sat Trinity exams under our guidance have earned Merit or Distinction.** This isn't a miracle. It's a system. Here is the exact blueprint.

✗ REGULAR MUSIC SCHOOL

MON

TUE

WED

THU

FRI

SAT

SUN

■ Class

■ Unguided

✗ No homework assigned

✗ No practice tracking

✗ Student guesses what to work on

✓ THE HSM METHOD

MON

TUE

WED

THU

FRI

SAT

SUN

■ Class

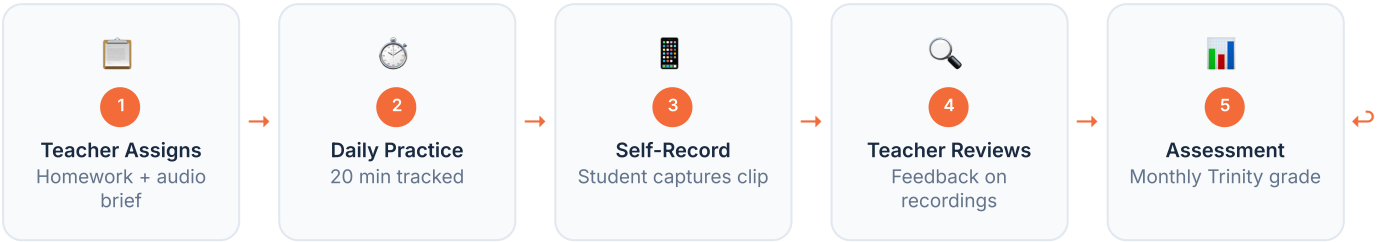
■ Tracked practice

✓ Homework assigned every class

✓ Daily streak tracked in portal

✓ Teacher reviews recordings remotely

The HSM Feedback Loop — repeats every week



Setting the Conditions for Success

HABIT 1



The Rule of Zero Friction

"Distinction students don't practise more because they have more willpower; they practise more because their instrument is impossible to ignore."

✗ THE TRAP

Most parents pack their child's guitar away in a heavy zippered gig bag after class, or pile textbooks on top of the keyboard lid. When it's time to practise, the child has to uncover, unpack, set up, and plug in — that minor friction is enough to make them choose video games instead.

✓ THE HSM METHOD

Top students keep their instruments out, tuned, and completely uncovered in a dedicated "music corner." The book stand is open to the correct page. The drumsticks are sitting right on the snare pad. Always ready to play in under 10 seconds.

THE GOAL **Reduce the physical time it takes to start playing to less than 10 seconds.**

HABIT 2



The 20-Minute Micro-Dose

"20 minutes of daily deliberate practice builds muscle memory 7x faster than a frantic 2-hour jam session the night before class."

✗ THE TRAP

The classic Sunday-night panic. The student hasn't touched their instrument all week, so they try to cram a week's worth of learning into one long, gruelling session. This causes mental burnout and physical hand fatigue — and none of the skills stick.

✓ THE HSM METHOD

Our brains build *myelin* — the insulation around neural pathways that creates muscle memory — through frequent, short repetitions. Distinction students track their daily streaks using the **HSM Daily 10 Habit Tracker** and focus on hyper-focused 20-minute sessions, six days a week.

THE GOAL **6 days of 20-minute practice will always beat 1 day of a 120-minute practice. Build the streak.**

Practising Smarter, Not Longer

HABIT 3



Extreme Isolation

"Amateurs practise a song from start to finish until they get it right. Professionals isolate the hardest 2 bars and repeat them until they can't get them wrong."

✗ THE TRAP

When a student sits down, they instinctively play the parts they are already good at — usually the intro. When they hit a difficult chord change or a complex rhythm bridge, they stumble through it, make a mistake, disregard it, and keep playing. They are essentially practising their mistakes.

✓ THE HSM METHOD

Our faculty teaches "micro-targeting." If bars 9 and 10 of a Trinity piece are problematic, the student turns off the rest of the song. They loop just those two bars at half-speed with a metronome, repeating them perfectly 5 times before moving on. Isolate. Fix. Re-integrate.

THE GOAL *Never practise an entire song if only two bars are broken. Isolate, fix, and re-integrate.*

HABIT 4



Closing the Feedback Loop

"The ear is a poor judge while the fingers are working. The camera never lies."

✗ THE TRAP

While playing, a student's brain is completely overwhelmed with tracking finger positions, reading notation, and keeping time. They literally cannot hear the subtle mistakes they are making in tone, timing, or vocal pitch — until an examiner points them out on results day.

✓ THE HSM METHOD

Distinction students treat practice like elite athletes treat game tape. They spend 60 seconds setting up a smartphone to record a quick clip. When they play it back, they instantly notice bad posture, rushed timing, or improper wrist bowing — and correct it themselves before the next class.

THE GOAL *Record one snippet a day. Self-correction is the fastest shortcut to an examiner's praise.*

Measuring What Matters

HABIT 5



The Assessment Anchor

"Progress that isn't measured simply isn't happening."

✗ THE TRAP

Students and parents often operate in a blind spot, guessing whether they are ready for a global Trinity Exam based on "how the song sounds" at home. Without data, preparation is wishful thinking — and the exam result often reflects that.

✓ THE HSM METHOD

Distinction students never guess. They rely on data inside the **HSM Student Portal**. Every month, our instructors perform formal assessments on technical scales, sight-reading, and performance pieces — graded against strict Trinity criteria. Students see exactly where their weaknesses lie and what to fix before the next assessment.

THE GOAL *Treat music like an elite academic subject. Use data to map the exact path from Grade 1 to Grade 8.*

A MESSAGE TO PARENTS

Great musicians aren't born; they are **built through structured, daily environments**. By enrolling your child in HSM, you aren't just paying for an instructor's time — you are gaining access to a world-class framework of accountability, **custom habit-tracking technology**, and mentors with over a decade of performance experience who care deeply about your child's success.

Ready to see the HSM Method in action? Come to our **Special Demo Day** — let your child test-drive our instruments and see the habit-tracking portal live, with no commitment.

Claim your free Demo Day pass → hsm.org.in/demoday

The Numbers Behind the Method

100%

Merit or Distinction in Trinity exams

100+

Active students across 9 streams

4.9★

Average Google rating

"The teachers are outstanding — they break down concepts from the very basics. The dedicated practice system keeps my child on track even on days I can't supervise."

— Kishore Gandhi, Guitar student

"My son is learning drums and my wife has joined for advanced Hindustani lessons. Both are making amazing progress. The portal homework system means they always know what to practise — no wasted days."

— Bharath Raj Kuttikad, Parent

OUR FACULTY

Our faculty bring conservatory-level training and a decade of performance experience — and every one of them is trained in The HSM Method.

J

Joshua

Keyboard & Guitar

M

Mriganko

Piano & Guitar

S

Subroto Bhaduri

Drums · Tabla · Octopad

I

Isaac Lawrence

Violin

S

Sangeeta

Hindustani & Carnatic
Vocals

Internationally recognised curriculum. Our teaching across 7 instruments follows the Trinity College London graded exam syllabus — Grade 1 through Grade 8 — a clear, internationally recognised progression from first note to performance-ready.



Experience the **HSM Method** in person.

Book a free demo class and let your child test-drive our instruments, meet our faculty, and see the HSM Daily 10 Habit Tracker live. No commitment. No credit card.

Book Your Free Demo → hsm.org.in

INSTRUMENTS

Guitar · Piano · Keyboard · Drums
Tabla · Octopad · Violin · Vocals

SCHEDULE

Tue–Fri: 5pm–9pm
Sat: 3pm–9pm · Sun: 10am–1pm & 5pm–9pm